



By Abhijit Dasgupta

It's called *Le Chhakka* and it stars a Mumbai import who really wanted to be a cricketer. Made for Rs 2 crore by Raj Chakrabarty and up for release soon, this film on street cricket epitomises the revolution that has come to Bengali cinema. Freeing itself from the trap of remakes and near copy-paste jobs of southern hits, Tollywood is morphing into its 21st century avatar, thanks to a new crop of filmmakers.

It all started with the box office success of atypical potboilers last year which not only won critical acclaim but also made money. Filmmakers

Eastern PROMISE

No longer a remake factory, the Bengali film industry is rediscovering itself, and finding profit in path-breaking plots, as it experiments with genres and actors